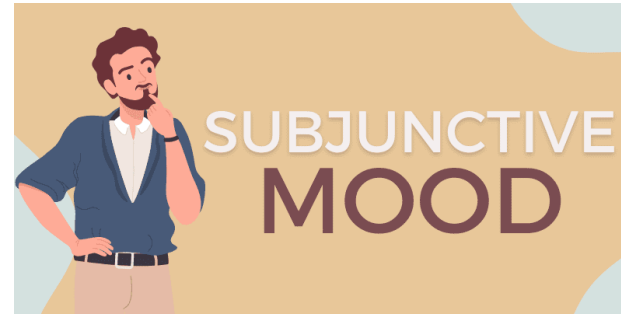




SUBJUNCTIVE MOOD

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1. What is "Mood" in Grammar?

In English, "Mood" doesn't mean happy or sad. It refers to the attitude of the speaker. It tells us if the speaker is:

- Stating a fact (**Indicative Mood**): **He is a doctor.**
- Giving a command (**Imperative Mood**): **Sit down!**
- Talking about something imaginary, a wish, or a requirement (**Subjunctive Mood**).
- Think of the Subjunctive Mood as the "Unreal" mood. It deals with things that aren't necessarily facts yet.

2. The 'Present' Subjunctive

We use this when someone demands, suggests, or insists that something be done.

The Golden Rule

In the Present Subjunctive, we always use the Base Form (V1) of the verb, no matter what the subject is.

- No **-S** Form (even for *He/She/It*).
- No "**to**" before the verb.
- For the verb "to be," we use **be** (**not** am/is/are).

2. The 'Present' Subjunctive

We use this when someone demands, suggests, or insists that something be done.

Structure:

Subject-1 + Verb (Demand/Suggest) + **THAT** + Subject-2 + **Base Verb (V1)**

Common Trigger Verbs:

Demand, Suggest, Recommend, Insist, Order, Propose, Advise, Request.
(Can be Past **or** Present)

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(Can be Past or Present)

- The teacher **insisted that** every student **remain** (not remains) silent.
- I **suggest that** he **apply** (not applies) for the job.
- The law **demands that** everyone **be** (not is) treated equally.
- The doctor **recommended that** she **take** (not takes) a holiday.
- It **is essential that** he **be** (not is) told the truth.

2. The Present Subjunctive

Examples:

- The manager **ordered** that the work **be** finished by evening.
- I **propose** that the meeting **be** postponed.
- She **requested** that he not **go** (not doesn't go) there.
- It **is important** that John **study** hard for the CGL exam.
- The court **decreed** that the prisoner **be** released.

Wrong vs. Correct

- **Wrong:** The Captain ordered that the soldier quits his post.
- **Correct:** The Captain ordered that the soldier **quit** his post.
- **Explanation:** Even though "soldier" is singular, "ordered" triggers the subjunctive, requiring the base form "quit."

3. The 'Past' Subjunctive

We use this for hypothetical (imaginary) situations, wishes, or things that are contrary to reality.

The Golden Rule

- For the verb "to be," we always use "**WERE**," regardless of the subject (**I, He, She, It, They**).
- We **never** use "**was**" in this mood.

Common Structures

- If I were... (Imagining being someone else)
- I wish... (Regretting the current reality)
- As if / As though... (Comparing reality to a fantasy)

3. The 'Past' Subjunctive

Common Structures

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 - I wish... (Regretting the current reality)
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- If **I were** a bird, I would fly to you. (I am not a bird).
 - I **wish I were** the Prime Minister. (I am not).
 - He talks **as if he were** my boss. (He is not my boss).
 - If **she were** here, she would help us. (She is absent).
 - I **wish it were** Sunday today. (It is not Sunday).

3. The 'Past' Subjunctive

Common Structures

- If I were... (Imagining being someone else)
- I wish... (Regretting the current reality)
- As if / As though... (Comparing reality to a fantasy)
- He behaves **as though he were** a millionaire. (He is poor).
- If **it were** easy, everyone would do it.
- Suppose **you were** the King, what would you do?
- I wish **he were** more polite.
- If **I were** you, I would accept the offer.

4. Subjunctive: The Traps

Trap 1:

The "Was" vs "Were" Trap

Question: "If he was the President, he would change the law."

Correction: Change "was" to "were."

In "If" clauses showing imagination, "was" is always wrong in competitive exams.

"If he **were** the President, he would change the law."

4. Subjunctive: The Traps

Trap 2:

The Singular Subject Trap

Question: "The Principal suggested that Rohan attends the seminar."

Correction: Change "attends" to "attend."

Because of the word "suggested," we must use V1 without **-s**.

"The Principal suggested that Rohan **attend** the seminar."

4. Subjunctive: The Traps

Trap 3:

The "Would" Trap

Question: "I wish I *would be* a child again."

Correction: "I wish I *were* a child again."

Indicative vs. Subjunctive

Indicative vs. Subjunctive

Indicative (Fact)

He **is** a king.

She **takes** the bus.

It **is** important.

Subjunctive (Wish/Demand)

I wish he **were** a king.

I suggest she **take** the bus.

It is vital that it **be** done.

Present vs. Past Subjunctive

Type	Purpose	Key Verb Form
Present	Requirement / Suggestion	Base Form (V1/Be)
Past	Imaginary / Unreal	Were / V2

Let's Check!

1. It is high time / that we / start / the work.
2. I wish / I was / a billionaire / like Elon Musk.
3. The board recommended / that the candidate / is / rejected.
4. If I was you / I would / never forgive him.
5. He commands me / as if / I am / his servant.
6. The judge ordered / that the witness / speaks / the truth.
7. It is essential / that every citizen / pays / taxes.
8. I suggest / that she / goes / to the doctor immediately.
9. Suppose / you are / an alien / what would you do?
10. It is important / that he / be / present at the meeting.

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Beware!

1. It is high time / that we / started / the work.

When we use phrases like **It is time**, **It is high time**, or **It is about time**, we are expressing a situation that is contrary to fact or overdue. Even though we are talking about the present or future, **we must use the Past Simple** tense in the following clause.

This is a specific use of the Subjunctive Mood, used to imply that the action should have already happened.

Why the Past Tense?

The use of the past tense (started) functions as a "distancing" mechanism. It indicates that the timing is **not "now," but rather "past due."**

- "It is time to start" (**Infinitive**): Neutral; it is simply the right moment.
- "It is high time we started" (**Past Subjunctive**): Emphatic; we are late, and the action is overdue.

It is time, It is high time, or It is about time,

Structure	Example	Nuance
It is time + to-infinitive	It is time to go.	General statement of the correct time.
It is time + Subject + Past Simple	It is time we went .	Suggests we are a bit late.
It is high time + Subject + Past Simple	It is high time we went .	Stronger emphasis on being overdue.

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It is time, It is high time, or It is about time,

1. **Incorrect:** It is high time the government **takes** action against pollution.

Correct: It is high time the government **took** action against pollution.

2. **Incorrect:** It is about time you **finish** your homework.

Correct: It is about time you **finished** your homework.

Note for Exam Aspirants: If the sentence does not have a subject after "time," use the infinitive (e.g., *It is time to start*). If there is a subject (e.g., *we, he, they*), the verb **must** be in the past tense.

Let's Check!

I suggest that he should go home.

(a) goes

(b) go

(c) went

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

I suggest that he should go home.

(a) goes

(b) go

(c) went

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

If I was he, I would kill him.

(a) am

(b) were

(c) had been

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

If I was he, I would kill him.

(a) am

(b) were

(c) had been

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

I wish I knew her name.

(a) know

(b) have known

(c) No improvement

Let's Check!

I wish I knew her name.

(a) know

(b) have known

(c) **No improvement** (V2 is correct for current wishes).

Let's Check!

The doctor insisted that the patient is operated on.

(a) be

(b) was

(c) being

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

The doctor insisted that the patient is operated on.

(a) be

(b) was

(c) being

(d) No improvement

Let's Check!

It is time we leave.

- (a) left
- (b) have left
- (c) will leave
- (d) No improvement

Let's Check!

1. If I _____ (was/were) you, I wouldn't do that.
2. The boss demanded that she _____
(finish/finishes) the report.
3. I wish it _____ (was/were) not raining.
4. It is necessary that he _____ (be/is) told.
5. He acts as though he _____ (is/were) mad.

Let's Check!

1. If I _____ (was/**were**) you, I wouldn't do that.
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3. I wish it _____ (was/**were**) not raining.
4. It is necessary that he _____ (**be**/is) told.
5. He acts as though he _____ (is/**were**) mad.

Revision

Rule 1: After Suggest, Demand, Insist, Recommend, Order, Essential, Vital, **use V1** (no **-s**, no **-es**).

Rule 2: After If, I wish, As if, As though, Suppose, use **WERE** for all subjects.

Rule 3: After **It is time / It is high time**, **use V2** (Past Simple).

Rule 4: "**Be**" is the subjunctive form of "**is/am/are**."